

U.S. B1 visa Path

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U.S. B1 visa Path

1. Purpose

This document outlines the procedure for an employee to apply for a U.S. B1 visa for business purposes.

2. Procedure

To apply for a B1 visa, the following steps are to be followed:

1. Complete Form DS-160.
2. Pay the B1 visa fees.
3. Schedule your visa interview.
4. Prepare your B1 visa documents.
5. Attend the interview:
 - Document validation and biometrics on Day 1.
 - Interview with the Consulate officer on Day 2.

2.1. Complete Form DS-160

Electronically submitting your DS-160 online application is only the first step in the visa application process. After submitting your DS-160 online, you must contact the U.S. embassy or consulate where you wish to apply to confirm whether you need to be interviewed by a consular officer and to schedule an interview. You can find a list of U.S. embassies and consulates [here](#), with links to their websites where you can find information about scheduling a visa interview appointment.

DS-160 Form Filling Instructions

1. Go to the Consular Electronic Application Center website (<https://ceac.state.gov/genniv/>).
2. Create an account if this is your first time, or log in to your account if you already have one.
3. Complete the security question.
4. Start answering the questions.
5. Upload your DS-160 form photo.
6. Submit the form.
7. Print the DS-160 barcode page.

2.1.1. Login

Next, log in and start completing the form. You will have several questions to answer. First, select the location where you will apply for your visa. Then, click on the “Start an Application” button if this is your first application.

The screenshot shows the U.S. Department of State Consular Electronic Application Center (CEAC) website. The header includes the U.S. Department of State logo and the text "U.S. DEPARTMENT of STATE CONSULAR ELECTRONIC APPLICATION CENTER". Below the header, the page title is "Online Nonimmigrant Visa Application (DS-160)". The main heading is "Apply For a Nonimmigrant Visa". There is a "FAQs" button in the top right corner. The page is divided into several sections: "Webinar!", "Get Started", "Important: Before You Start", and "Additional Information". The "Get Started" section includes a dropdown menu to "Select a location where you will be applying for this visa" and a "SELECT ONE" button. Below this is a "Enter the code as shown:" field with a CAPTCHA image showing the letters "WELER4". The "Important: Before You Start" section contains a list of links: "Learn about Types of Visas", "List of Documents and Information you will need", "Responsible Requirements", and "How to complete the application". The "Additional Information" section includes links to "Read more about U.S. visas at travel.state.gov" and "Visit the website of the U.S. Embassy or Consulate". At the bottom, there is a disclaimer: "This site is managed by the Bureau of Consular Affairs, U.S. Department of State. External links to other Internet sites should not be construed as an endorsement of the views contained therein." and links to "Consular Information", "Disclaimer", and "Privacy Statement".

2.1.2. Complete the Security Question

You need to complete this part to get a unique application ID and for online security purposes. Choose a security question and remember the answer you provide, as you may need it for your next login.

U.S. DEPARTMENT of STATE
CONSULAR ELECTRONIC APPLICATION CENTER

Online Nonimmigrant Visa Application (DS-160)

Application Information

Please record your Application ID in a safe and secure place.
If there are technical issues with the system, or you want to complete your application some other time, you can save your work and later start where you left off. In order to access your application later, however, you will need: (1) your Application ID, and (2) the answer to the security question that you will choose on this page.

To choose a security question, pick the one you like the best from the dropdown list, type your answer to that question in the box below, and click "Continue." Remember: In order to access your application later, you will need to know the answer **exactly as you wrote it on this page.**

You can also use your Application ID and security question to retrieve your Confirmation Page after you have submitted your application, or to use your previously provided application information to complete a new application at a later date.

If you do not plan to complete your application within the next 30 days, download your application to your computer by clicking the "Save" button at the bottom of the last completed page. Follow the instructions. When you are ready to complete your application, select "Upload an Application". NOTE: Only download your application to a computer that cannot be accessed by anyone who does not have your permission to see or record your personal data. If you download your application a shared or public computer, such as a computer in a cyber cafe or library, your personal information may be able to be accessed by other users.

Note: Electronically submitting your DS-160 online application is the **FIRST STEP** in the visa application process. The next step is to review the internet page of the [ambassy or consulate](#) where you plan to apply for your visa. Most visa applicants will need to schedule a visa interview, though some applicants may qualify for visa renewal. The [ambassy or consulate](#) information may include specific local instructions about scheduling interviews, submitting your visa application, and other frequently asked questions.

Your Application ID is:
AA009721BD

Date:
05-AUG-2019

[Print Application ID](#)

Security Question
WHAT IS THE GIVEN NAME OF YOUR MOTHER'S MOTHER?

Answer

[Continue](#) [Cancel](#)

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2.1.3. Start Answering the Questions

After completing the first two pages of the application form, start answering the questions related to your application. The questions are grouped into four categories:

1. Personal information
2. Family information
3. Work/education/training information
4. Security-related information
5. Location information
6. U.S. Contact Information
7. Travel Information

All the questions are highlighted in the Annexure section.

2.1.4. Upload your DS-160 form photo

Photo Requirements

Your photo is a vital part of your visa application. Digital images are required for some visa categories, while printed photos are required for others. The acceptance of your digital image or photo is at the discretion of the U.S. embassy or consulate where you apply.

Your photos or digital images must:

- Be in colour.
- Be sized such that the head is between 1 inch and 1 3/8 inches (22 mm and 35 mm), or 50% and 69% of the image's total height from the bottom of the chin to the top of the head. Refer to the Photo Composition Template for more size requirements.
- Be taken within the last 6 months to reflect your current appearance.
- Be taken in front of a plain white or off-white background.
- Show a full-face view directly facing the camera.
- Be taken with a neutral facial expression and both eyes open.
- Be taken in clothing that you normally wear daily.
- Uniforms should not be worn in your photo, except for religious clothing that is worn daily.
- Not include hats or head coverings that obscure the hair or hairline, unless worn daily for religious purposes. Your full face must be visible, and the head covering must not cast any shadows on your face.
- Not include headphones, wireless hands-free devices, or similar items.
- Not include eyeglasses, except in rare circumstances when they cannot be removed for medical reasons (e.g., recent ocular surgery). A medical statement signed by a medical professional or health practitioner must be provided in these cases. If eyeglasses are accepted for medical reasons:
 - The frames must not cover the eye(s).
 - There must be no glare on the eyeglasses that obscures the eye(s).
 - There must be no shadows or refractions from the eyeglasses that obscure the eye(s).
- Include any hearing devices or related articles if you normally wear them.

Review the [Photo Examples](#) to see acceptable and unacceptable photos. Photos copied or digitally scanned from driver's licenses or other official documents are not acceptable. Additionally, snapshots, magazine photos, low-quality vending machine or mobile phone photos, and full-length photographs are not acceptable.

2.1.5. Submit the Form

After successfully uploading the photo, you will receive information about the location where you should submit your application for a U.S. non-immigrant visa.

Next, you will need to electronically sign the application by clicking on the “*Sign and Submit Application*” button.

This will complete the first step of your application for a U.S. non-immigrant visa.

2.1.6. Print DS-160 Barcode Page

Once you are done, you will be presented with a confirmation page, which you need to print and bring with you on the day of your U.S. visa interview. Without the DS-160 form confirmation, you will be unable to attend your interview.

2.2. Pay the B1 Visa Fees

You must pay the B1 visa fee to continue with your application. In addition to the application fee, you might also need to pay other fees, such as visa issuance fees. The amount of visa issuance fees depends on the relationship between your home country and the U.S. After paying all fees, make sure to save the receipts to attach to your documents.

2.3. Schedule Your Visa Interview

Interviews are required for visa applicants, with certain limited exceptions. Consular officers may require an interview for any visa applicant.

You should schedule an appointment for your visa interview at the [U.S. Embassy or Consulate](#) in the country where you live. You may also schedule your interview at another U.S. Embassy or Consulate where you will be present; however, be aware that it may be more difficult to demonstrate your qualifications for a visa outside of the country where you live.

Wait times for interview appointments vary by location, season, and visa category, so you should apply for your visa early. Review the interview wait times for the location where you will apply.

2.4. Prepare Your B1 Visa Documents

You must provide the commonly required documents for the business visa application to support your application. Gather and prepare the following required documents before your visa interview:

- **Passport valid for travel to the United States:** Your passport must be valid for at least six months beyond your period of stay in the United States ([unless exempt by country-specific agreements](#)). Everyone who needs a visa must submit a separate application, including any family members listed in your passport.
- **Non-immigrant Visa Application, Form DS-160 confirmation page.**
- **Application fee payment receipt:** If you are required to pay before your interview.
- **Photo:** You will upload your photo while completing the online Form DS-160. If the [photo upload fails](#), you must bring one printed photo in the format explained in the [Photograph Requirements](#).

2.4.1. Additional Documentation May Be Required

Review the instructions for how to apply for a visa on the website of the [U.S. Embassy or Consulate](#) where you will apply. Additional documents may be requested to establish your qualifications. For example, additional requested documents may include evidence of:

- The purpose of your trip
- Your intent to depart the United States after your trip
- Your ability to pay all costs of the trip

Evidence of your employment and/or family ties may be sufficient to show the purpose of your trip and your intent to return to your home country. If you cannot cover all the costs of your trip, you may show evidence that another person will cover some or all costs.

2.5. Attend the interview

A consular officer will interview you to determine whether you are qualified to receive a visitor visa. You must establish that you meet the requirements under U.S. law to receive a visa. Ink-free digital fingerprint scans are taken as part of the application process; they are usually taken during your interview, but this can vary based on location.

After your visa interview, the consular officer may determine that your application requires further [administrative processing](#). The consular officer will inform you if this is the case.

Once the visa is approved, you may need to pay a visa issuance fee (if applicable to your nationality) and arrange for the return of your passport and visa. Review the [visa processing time](#) to learn more.

Annexure

All the DS-160 Application Form Questions

1. Personal Information:

- Name Provided
- Full Name in Native Language
- Other Names Used
- Telecode Name Used
- Sex
- Marital Status
- Date of Birth
- Place of Birth
- Country/Region of Origin (Nationality)
- Do you hold or have you held any nationality other than the one Indicated above on nationality?
- Are you a permanent resident of a country/region other than your country/region of origin (nationality) above?
- National Identification Number
- U.S. Social Security Number
- U.S. Taxpayer ID Number
- Home Address
- City
- State/Province
- Postal Zone/ZIP Code
- Country/Region
- Same Mailing Address?
- Primary Phone Number
- Secondary Phone Number
- Work Phone Number
- Do you have any additional phone numbers?
- Additional Phone: (1)
- Email Address
- Do you have any additional email addresses?
- Additional Email: (1)
- Do you have a social media presence?
- Social Media Platform: (1)

- Social Media Identifier
- Social Media Platform: (3)
- Social Media Identifier
- Social Media Platform: (4)
- Social Media Identifier
- Do you have any additional social media presence?
- Passport/Travel Document Type
- Passport/Travel Document Number
- Passport Book Number
- Country/Authority that Issued Passport/Travel Document
- City Where Issued
- Country/Region Where Issued
- Issuance Date
- Expiration Date
- Have you ever lost a passport or had one stolen?

2. Family Information:

- Father's Surnames
- Father's Given Names
- Father's Date of Birth
- Is your father in the U.S.?
- Mother's Surnames
- Mother's Given Names
- Mother's Date of Birth
- Is your mother in the U.S.?
- Do you have any immediate relatives, not including parents in the U.S.?
- Do you have any other relatives in the United States?
- Spouse's Full Name
- Spouse's Date of Birth
- Spouse's Country/Region of Origin (Nationality)
- Spouse's City of Birth
- Spouse's Country/Region of Birth
- Spouse's Address

3. Work / Education / Training Information:

- Primary Occupation
- Present Employer or School Name
- Address
- City
- State/Province
- Postal Zone/Zip Code
- Country/Region
- Work Phone Number
- Monthly Salary in Local Currency (if employed)
- Briefly Describe your Duties
- Were you previously employed?
- Have you attended any educational institutions at a secondary level or above?
- Name of Institution (1)
- Address of Institution:
 - City
 - State/Province
 - Postal Zone/ZIP Code
 - Country/Region
- Course of Study
- Date of Attendance From
- Date of Attendance To
- Do you belong to a clan or tribe?
- Provide a List of Languages You Speak
 - Language Name (1)
 - Language Name (2)
 - Language Name (3)
 - Language Name (4)
- Have you travelled to any countries/regions within the last five years?
- Provide a List of Countries/Regions Visited
 - Country/Region (1)
 - Country/Region (2)
- Have you belonged to, contributed to, or worked for any professional, social, or charitable organization?
- Do you have any specialized skills or training, such as firearms, explosives, nuclear, biological, or chemical experience?
- Have you ever served in the military?
- Have you ever served in, been a member of, or been involved with a paramilitary unit, vigilante unit, rebel group, guerrilla group, or insurgent organization?

4. Security and Background Information:

- Do you have a communicable disease of public health significance? (Communicable diseases of public significance include chancroid, gonorrhea, granuloma inguinale, infectious leprosy, lymphogranuloma venereum, infectious stage syphilis, active tuberculosis, and other diseases as determined by the Department of Health and Human Services.)
- Do you have a mental or physical disorder that poses or is likely to pose a threat to the safety or welfare of yourself or others?
- Are you or have you ever been a drug abuser or addict?
- Have you ever been arrested or convicted for any offense or crime, even though subject of a pardon, amnesty, or other similar action?
- Have you ever violated, or engaged in a conspiracy to violate, any law relating to controlled substances?
- Are you coming to the United States to engage in prostitution or unlawful commercialized vice or have you been engaged in prostitution or procuring prostitutes within the past 10 years?
- Have you ever been involved in, or do you seek to engage in, money laundering?
- Have you ever committed or conspired to commit a human trafficking offense in the United States or outside the United States?
- Are you the spouse, son, or daughter of an individual who has committed or conspired to commit a human trafficking offense in the United States or outside the United States and have you within the last five years, knowingly benefited from the trafficking activities?
- Have you knowingly aided, abetted, assisted, or colluded with an individual who has committed or conspired to commit a severe human trafficking offense in the United States or outside the United States?
- Do you seek to engage in espionage, sabotage, export control violations, or any other illegal activity while in the United States?
- Do you seek to engage in terrorist activities while in the United States or have you ever engaged in terrorist activities?
- Have you ever or do you intend to provide financial assistance or other support to terrorists or terrorist organizations?
- Are you a member or representative of a terrorist organization?
- Are you the spouse, son, or daughter of an individual who has engaged in terrorist activity, including providing financial assistance or other support to terrorists or terrorist organizations, in the last five years?
- Have you ever ordered, incited, committed, assisted, or otherwise participated in genocide?

- Have you ever committed, ordered, incited, assisted, or otherwise participated in torture?
- Have you committed, ordered, incited, assisted, or otherwise participated in extrajudicial killings, political killings, or other acts of violence?
- Have you ever engaged in the recruitment or the use of the child soldiers?
- Have you, while serving as a government official, been responsible for or directly carried out, at any time, particularly severe violations of religious freedom?
- Have you ever been directly involved in the establishment or enforcement of the population controls forcing a woman to undergo an abortion against her free choice or a man or a woman to undergo sterilization against his or her free will?
- Have you ever been directly involved in the coercive transplantation of human organs or bodily tissue?
- Have you ever sought to obtain or assist others to obtain a visa, entry into the United States, or any other United States immigration benefit by fraud or wilful misrepresentation or other unlawful means?
- Have you ever been removed or deported from any country?
- Have you ever withheld custody of a U.S. citizen child outside the United States from a person granted legal custody by a U.S. court?
- Have you voted in the United States in violation of any law or regulation?
- Have you ever renounced United States citizenship for the purpose of avoiding taxation?

5. Location Information:

- Location where you will be submitting your application?
- Current Location
- Preparer of Application
- Did anyone assist you in filling out this application?

6. U.S. Contact Information:

- Contact Person Name in the U.S.
- Organization Name in the U.S.
- Relationship to You
- U.S. Contact Address
- Phone Number
- Email Address

Reach out to the India HR team to know about the U.S. Contact Information.

7. Travel Information:

- The List of Purposes of Trip to the U.S
- Purpose of Trip to the U.S. (1)
- Specify
- Have you made specific travel plans?
- Provide a complete itinerary for your travel to the U.S.
- Date of Arrival in the U.S.
- Arrival City
- Date of Departure from U.S.
- Address where you will stay in the U.S.
- Person/Entity Paying for Your Trip
- Are there other persons traveling with you?
- Have you ever been in the U.S.?
- Have you ever been issued a U.S. visa?
- Have you ever been refused a U.S. Visa, or been refused admission to the United States, or withdrawn your application for admission at the port of entry?
- Has anyone ever filed an immigrant petition on your behalf with the United States Citizenship and Immigration Services?

FAQs

DS-160 Form Validity:

The DS-160 form is valid for 30 days from the day you start completing it. For example, if you start applying on January 1, the DS-160 form will expire by January 31. Make sure you complete the form on time, or you will need to start it from the beginning.

DS-160 Form Visa Fee:

There is no fee for submitting the DS-160 form. However, you will need to pay the fee for the specific U.S. visa you are applying for.

What is the DS-160 Confirmation Number?

The DS-160 confirmation number is the number you receive once you complete, sign, and submit the form. This number serves as confirmation that you have completed this step.

Can the DS-160 Form Be Edited After Submission?

Corrections to the DS-160 form are not possible once you have signed and submitted it. However, you can make changes in two ways:

- 1.If you submitted the form within the last 30 days, you can retrieve your application from the Consular Electronic Application Center system and edit it.
- 2.The other option is to fill out a completely new application. You must bring the confirmation pages from both the original and revised Form DS-160 on the day of your appointment.

How to Retrieve the DS-160 Form After Submission?

You can retrieve your DS-160 visa application within 30 days from the day you signed and submitted it. Follow the steps below:

- 1.Log into the Consular Electronic Application Center system.
- 2.Enter your application identification number.
- 3.Select “Retrieve an Application.”
- 4.Create a new application, which will cause the entire prior application to appear.
- 5.Edit the information as needed.
- 6.Re-submit the application.

India HR Point of Contacts:**Kanaga Dhanasekar:****Designation:** Senior HR - Business Partner**Email / Teams:** kdhanasekar@presidio.com**Jeffrey Giftson Jeshurun:****Designation:** HR Specialist**Email / Teams:** [jjeshurun@presidio.com](mailto:jgjeshurun@presidio.com)